

Define Problem Statements

Project: Employee Software Installation Request
(ServiceNow)

1. Context

In modern organizations, employees require licensed software such as Microsoft Office, Adobe Photoshop, AutoCAD, and other business applications to perform their daily tasks efficiently. However, the existing software installation request process is mostly handled through emails or verbal communication with the IT department. Since there is no standardized process, requests are often delayed, misplaced, or lack proper approval and tracking.

To overcome these challenges, the project proposes a workflow-driven software installation request system using the ServiceNow platform.

2. Core Problem Statement

Problem Statement

Employees currently do not have a standardized and trackable method to request licensed software installations. As a result, software requests experience delays, approvals are handled inconsistently, and there is no visibility into software license availability. This creates inefficiencies for employees, managers, and the IT support team while reducing overall productivity and accountability.

3. Supporting Problem Statements

Employee

Employees need a simple and structured way to request software. The current process does not provide visibility into the status of their request, making it difficult to know whether it has been received, approved, or is being processed by the IT team.

Manager

Managers receive software installation requests through emails or verbal communication, making it difficult to review, approve, or reject requests consistently. There is also no centralized record of approval decisions for future reference or auditing.

IT / Network Team

The IT and Network Support teams receive requests with incomplete or inconsistent information. Without a structured task management system, it becomes difficult to prioritize requests, monitor progress, and ensure timely software installation.

Organization

The organization lacks a centralized system to maintain records of software requests, approvals, and installations. There is no proper audit trail or mechanism to monitor software license utilization, increasing the risk of license over-allocation and compliance issues.

4. Impact of the Problem

The absence of a standardized request process leads to several operational challenges:

- Delays in software installation reduce employee productivity.
- Managers do not have a consistent approval process or approval history for compliance purposes.
- IT teams spend additional time collecting missing information and manually tracking requests.
- Software license shortages are identified only after a request reaches the IT team, resulting in further delays.
- The organization lacks complete visibility into software requests, approvals, and license usage.

5. Desired Outcome

The objective of this project is to implement a digital, workflow-driven software installation request system using ServiceNow.

The proposed solution enables:

- Employees to submit software installation requests through a user-friendly Service Catalog form.
- Automatic routing of requests to the appropriate manager for approval.
- Automatic creation of fulfillment tasks for the IT/Network Support team after approval.
- Automatic generation of an incident whenever a software request cannot be fulfilled due to license unavailability.
- Complete tracking of every request from submission to completion, ensuring transparency and accountability throughout the process.

6. Success Criteria

The project will be considered successful when it achieves the following objectives:

- Employees can submit software installation requests quickly and easily through the ServiceNow Service Catalog.
- Managers can review, approve, or reject requests directly from the **My Approvals** workspace.
- Approved requests automatically generate fulfillment tasks assigned to the appropriate IT or Network Support team.
- Requests that cannot be completed because of license shortages automatically create incidents without requiring manual intervention.
- Every software request is fully traceable through each stage of the workflow, including **Requested → Approved/Rejected → In Progress → Completed/Closed**.
- The solution improves efficiency, reduces manual effort, and provides a reliable audit trail for all software installation requests.